

AKASH JAIN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technology Operations and Service Delivery leader with 20+ years stabilizing complex, regulated banking production environments. Track record of cutting customer-facing downtime by 75% through resiliency redesign, reducing alert noise by 80% across 50+ applications, and dropping failed-change rates from 10% to 1% through governance redesign — all without added headcount or vendor spend. Repeatedly identifies structural weaknesses in operating models, redesigns the approach, and secures executive buy-in to deliver measurable reductions in operational risk and customer impact. Complements this with entrepreneurial experience, having founded and run ventures spanning restaurant, transport, and solar energy.

SKILLS

Technology Operations & Service Delivery; Incident, Problem & Change Management; Operational Resilience & Disaster Recovery; Monitoring, Observability & AIOps (AppDynamics, ELK, Tealeaf); ITIL 4; Self-Healing Automation & SRE; Service Risk Assessment & Governance; Vendor & Third-Party Risk Management; Root Cause Analysis; Capacity Planning & Cost Optimization; Audit & Regulatory Readiness; Production Stability; Cross-Functional & Cross-Tower Leadership; ServiceNow; Banking & Financial Services Operations

EXPERIENCE

Vice President, Barclays

07/2019 - Present

Pune, India

- Redesigned disaster-recovery execution from sequential to parallel processing and automated the recovery sequence, cutting customer-facing downtime from 4 hours to 1 hour (75%) and avoiding roughly 160,000 cumulative customer-hours of disruption across 8 resiliency exercises.
- Built a 5-person governance squad to own the patching lifecycle end-to-end (weekly review cadence, scheduling, green-zone compliance, non-prod validation), cutting patching-related P1/P2 incidents from 34/year to 1 and eliminating recurring overtime costs; the model was adopted across other business units.
- Redesigned the change-approval process to close the three recurring causes of failed changes (untested non-prod environments, off-window deployments, untested rollback plans), cutting the failed-change rate from 10% to 1% over 3 years (60% YoY) across a banking estate serving ~10 million customers.
- Audited and overhauled alerting thresholds and embedded suppression discipline into runbooks across USCB platforms, cutting weekly monitoring events from ~3,500 to ~1,500 and saving ~\$156K annually in vendor event-handling costs while reducing L1 headcount requirement.
- Introduced self-healing and auto-restart capability ahead of ticket creation in a regulated banking environment, sustaining a ~30% year-on-year improvement cadence and reducing weekly incident volume from 1,000 to 450 (68% over 3-4 years), freeing ~160 engineer-hours per week (~\$320K/year in recovered capacity).
- Led pre-live validation on the GAP co-branded card portfolio migration (10 million customers, Barclays' largest-ever partner conversion), caught a data-replication failure before go-live, and secured a CIO-approved maintenance window extension to resolve it — delivering zero customer-facing failures at launch.
- Diagnosed a systemic single point of failure behind recurring Experian-linked major incidents, escalated the architectural gap directly to vendor leadership, and authored a recovery runbook — cutting major incidents from 44 to 9 annually and permanently altering a third-party vendor's architecture to protect Barclays' service.
- Identified unused server headroom and made the data-driven case to avoid planned 50-server procurement prior to partner launch, saving ~\$400K over 4 years (avoided capex plus sustained cloud-rightsizing savings) with zero performance impact at launch.

Senior Manager, Cognizant

08/2009 - 07/2019

Pune, India

- Owned end-to-end incident, problem, and change management for Barclays Enterprise Messaging (BEM), a business-critical active/active middleware platform, coordinating fixes and resolution across channel and backend teams.

- Maintained high availability and operational stability for BEM through structured out-of-hours coverage and disciplined production support, reducing the risk of unplanned outages on a critical-path platform.
- Acted as the cross-team escalation point for defect fixes and production issues, aligning channel and backend teams to keep resolution timelines on track.

Senior Software Engineer, Infosys

11/2005 - 07/2009

Pune, India

- Led the end-to-end migration of the American Express ABS EDI platform from legacy Gentran to Gentran Integration Suite, owning requirements analysis, development, and ETL integration through to production rollout.
- Directed merchant onboarding and post-implementation warranty support, ensuring platform stability through the full transition and stabilization period.
- Led offshore delivery and trained incoming team members, building the team's capability to support the platform independently after handover.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering: Electronics & Communication

AWARDS

GTSM Steward of Service — Recognized as a go-to leader, with 100+ eRecognitions for service excellence and stewardship; consistently top-rated performer across roles and organizations.